

Ottawa County Clerk of Courts

Website Accessibility Improvements Report — Final

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA | Date: May 2025 | Prepared by: Digital Kingdom Interprises

Project Scope: Audit and remediation of accessibility barriers across the Ottawa County Clerk of Courts website (*ottawacountyclerkofcourts.com*) to meet ADA compliance requirements under WCAG 2.1 Level AA. All 9 files — including shared header/navigation and footer — have been reviewed and corrected. Changes cover semantic HTML structure, ARIA attributes, keyboard navigation support, screen reader compatibility, heading hierarchy, image alt text, form labeling, link context, table accessibility, and iframe identification.

Pages Summary

File	Page / Component	Status	Fixes Applied
nav.php	Site-Wide Navigation	Complete	13
foot.php	Site-Wide Footer	Complete	6
index.php	Home Page	Complete	7
titles.php	Title Office	Complete	11
packets.php	Legal Packets	Complete	10
fees.php	Filing Fees	Complete	5
records.php	Public Records	Complete	5
contact.php	Contact	Complete	7
links.php	Links	Complete	1
Total Fixes Applied			65

nav.php — Site-Wide Navigation 13 fixes

- Added `role="alert"` to the notice/announcement div for screen reader announcements
- Added `aria-label="Site Header"` to the top utility navigation bar
- Added `aria-label="Main Navigation"` to the primary nav element
- Added `aria-label="Open navigation menu"` to the mobile hamburger button
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to the mobile menu icon (decorative)
- Added `aria-haspopup="true"` and `aria-expanded="false"` to all dropdown triggers
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to all dropdown caret/arrow icons (decorative)
- Added `aria-label="Pay Online (opens in new tab)"` to Pay Online links — desktop and mobile
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warnings to all Common Pleas external links
- Added `role="separator"` to visual divider list items
- Added `role="navigation"` `aria-label="Mobile Navigation"` to the mobile sidenav
- Added `aria-label="Clerk of Courts: Christopher Enoch"` to the name link
- Confirmed distinct `aria-label` values on both nav elements to avoid duplicate landmark names

foot.php — Site-Wide Footer 6 fixes

- Added `role="contentinfo"` to the footer element
- Changed `<h3>` site name to `<p>` — footer does not require a heading
- Wrapped mailing address in `<address>` semantic element
- Changed plain phone number text to `<a href="tel:...">` with `aria-label="Phone: 419-..."`
- Added `aria-label="Fax: 419-..."` to fax number
- Added `aria-label="... (opens in new tab)"` to external footer link

index.php — Home Page 7 fixes

- Updated page title: `Home | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts`
- Added skip navigation link: `<a href="#main-content" class="skip-link">Skip to main content</a>`
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper around page content
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to empty decorative banner div
- Changed `<div role="navigation">` to proper semantic `<nav>` element
- Added descriptive `alt` text to all service card images
- Confirmed single H1 heading per page structure

titles.php — Title Office 11 fixes

- Updated page title: `Titles | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to decorative arrow icon
- Changed service card headings from H4 to H3 — fixed heading skip H1 → H4 (Titles, Passports, Watercraft Registrations)
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrappers around `<ul>` lists in all 3 service cards
- Added phone tel link in Passports card: `<a href="tel:4197346752" aria-label="Phone: 419-734-6752">`
- Added `role="separator"` to divider list items in the contact info card
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 9 BMV automobile form links
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 3 Watercraft PDF links
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warnings to all external links (Ohio BMV, Ohio DNR, Ohio Tax)

packets.php — Legal Packets 10 fixes

- Updated page title: `Legal Packets | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Changed dynamically generated card headings from H4 to H2 — fixed heading skip H1 → H4
- Changed card-reveal panel title from H5 to `<p>` — avoids broken heading hierarchy inside expanded panels
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to `more_vert` Material icon (decorative)
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to `close` Material icon in card-reveal panel (decorative)
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrapper around `<ul>` document list in card-reveal
- Added dynamic `aria-label` with new tab warning to all external document links
- Added dynamic `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warning to all PDF document links

fees.php — Filing Fees 5 fixes

- Updated page title: `Filing Fees | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `id="main-content"` to the existing `<main>` element
- Replaced spanning `<th colspan="2">` table title with a proper `<caption>` element
- Added `<th scope="col">` column headers for both table columns (Filing Type / Fee)

records.php — Public Records 5 fixes

- Updated page title: `Public Records | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Changed both H3 notice headings to H2 — fixed heading skip H1 → H3
- Added `aria-label="I have read the disclaimer and wish to proceed (opens in new tab)"` to the external disclaimer button link

contact.php — Contact 7 fixes

- Changed H3 "Ottawa County Clerk of Courts" to H2 — fixed heading skip H1 → H3
- Changed H4 "Christopher Enoch, Clerk" to H3 — corrected heading hierarchy
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrapper around `<ul>` in contact card
- Removed invalid `<br>` tags inside `<ul>`
- Added `role="separator"` to divider `<li>` element
- Added phone tel link: `<a href="tel:4197346755" aria-label="Phone: 419-734-6755">`
- Added `title="Ottawa County Courthouse location map"` to Google Maps iframe
- Wrapped contact address block in semantic `<address>` element

links.php — Links 1 fix

- Added dynamic `aria-label="[link name] (opens in new tab)"` to all dynamically generated external links

Common Fixes Applied Across All Pages

- **Skip link:** `<a href="#main-content" class="skip-link">Skip to main content</a>` added to every page for keyboard navigation
- **Main landmark:** `<main id="main-content">` added to every page so the skip link target is valid
- **Page titles:** Every page given a unique, descriptive title in the format *Page Name | Ottawa County Clerk of Courts*
- **Heading hierarchy:** Each page verified to have one H1, with subsections using H2 and H3 in proper order — no skipped levels
- **External links:** All links opening in a new tab include an `aria-label` warning of "(opens in new tab)"
- **PDF links:** All PDF links include "PDF" and "(opens in new tab)" in their `aria-label`
- **Decorative icons:** All Material Icons used for decoration marked with `aria-hidden="true"`
- **Invalid HTML:** `<ul>` elements removed from inside `<p>` tags throughout